POLICY & RESEARCH INITIATIVE (PRI)

Work & Activity Report

1. About Us

The Policy and Research Initiative (PRI) is a dedicated think tank committed to promoting inclusive development, social justice, and national integration through data-driven research, evidence-based policy advocacy, and strategic collaborations. PRI brings together researchers, policymakers, community leaders, and civil society representatives to address socio-economic and political disparities, ensuring equal opportunities and fair representation.

1.1 Our Vision

"To create a society where every individual has equitable access to opportunities and resources. We envision an empowered society where all people can actively engage in socio-economic and political processes, fostering a culture of equity, inclusion, and mutual respect."

1.2 Our Mission

1. Conduct rigorous, **data-driven research** to identify and outline systemic inequalities.
2. Develop **evidence-based policies** and recommendations to address issues and problems.
3. Engage in **strategic advocacy efforts** with policymakers and key stakeholders to drive social justice and equality.
4. Empower decision-makers and the public through **knowledge sharing and capacity building**.

1.3 Our Functions

1. Research & Analysis Wing

The **Research & Analysis Wing** of the **Policy and Research Initiative (PRI)** is structured into five key departments for operational efficiency, ensuring a **multidisciplinary approach** that integrates **quantitative and qualitative methodologies**. This wing systematically examines **gaps, inequalities, and opportunities** across different societal sections and regional areas. By leveraging **data-driven insights**, PRI aims to develop **evidence-based solutions** that inform policymaking and support inclusive development.

1 - Center for Human Capital Development

- Educational Statistics
- Occupational and Employment Patterns
- Skill Development and Capacity Building
- Accessibility and Opportunities

2 - Center for Economic Analysis

- Wealth and Income Distribution
- Market Participation and Ownership Patterns
- Budget allocation and Expenditure
- Agriculture and Industry
- Public Infrastructure
- Environment and Resilience

3 - Department of Society Development

- Organizations and Community Institutions
- Philanthropic and Welfare Activities
- Inter-religious Harmony
- Resource Allocation and Optimization

4 - Center for Governance and Policy Analysis

- Public Policy Analysis
- Law and Judiciary
- Electoral Dynamics
- Political Participation and Legislative Representation
- Schemes and Programmes

5 - Demography & Health Research Unit

- Demography and Population Studies
- Migration and Remittances
- Healthcare Accessibility and Delivery

2. Data Repository & Digital Library

PRI's Data Repository serves as a centralized hub for all research and policy-related data, ensuring easy access and efficient management of information.

- **Data Hub:** A centralized data repository with controlled access, designed to store, manage, and analyze research datasets securely.

- **Library & Archives:** Comprehensive records of historical datasets, research papers, surveys, policy documents, and case studies.
- **Research Lab:** AI and technology-driven data lab to process and analyze complex datasets.
- **Documentation & Surveys:** Regular updates through systematic data collection, analysis, and record-keeping.

3. Outreach & Production House

The **Outreach & Production House** shapes public discourse by setting agendas, framing issues, and influencing narratives in line with PRI's objectives through strategic content, positive social media engagement, and targeted advocacy.

- **Academic Publications:** Journals, research articles, policy papers, technical briefs, statements and policy blogs
- **Media Monitoring:** Real-time issue tracking, news analysis, and proactive engagement.
- **Rapid Response:** Timely and research-backed responses to emerging socio-political issues to inform public debate.
- **Social Media:** Creating strategic multimedia content collaborating with influencers to ensure **last-mile reach.**

4. Policy Advocacy & Engagement

PRI actively engages in policy advocacy to ensure that research findings translate into actionable policies and solutions.

- **Policymaker Engagement:** Engaging with policymakers and government agencies to advocate for equitable policies.
- **Seminars & Workshops:** Creating platforms to share research, address problems, and collaboratively build solutions.
- **Training Programs:** Capacity-building workshops for community leaders and policymakers.
- **Leaders' Forum:** A platform for leaders to discuss and strategize on key issues.
- **Public Awareness:** Public campaigns to mobilize support for inclusive policies **and ensure grass root involvement**.

5. Networking & Collaboration

PRI's networking and collaboration efforts build robust alliances with researchers, institutions, government, and civil society. This synergy enhances participatory development and knowledge sharing.

- **Researchers' Society:** A network promoting collaboration among researchers and academicians across areas of expertise.
- **MOUs with NGOs & Institutes:** Developing MOUs to create partnerships with NGOs and institutes on key initiatives and shared objectives.
- **Fellowships & Internships:** Programs to train the next generation of researchers and policymakers.
- **Civil Society Engagement:** Building strong relationships with civil society for collaborative action and impact.

Government Partnerships: Partnering with government agencies to provide insights for improved public service delivery.

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2. Office & Researcher Workspace

PRI functions from a dedicated **1400 sq.ft. fully equipped research office** located at **West Kodur**, on the **State Highway connecting Malappuram and Tirur**.
The facility is designed to support **high-quality social science research, data analytics, and interdisciplinary collaboration**.

Infrastructure Overview

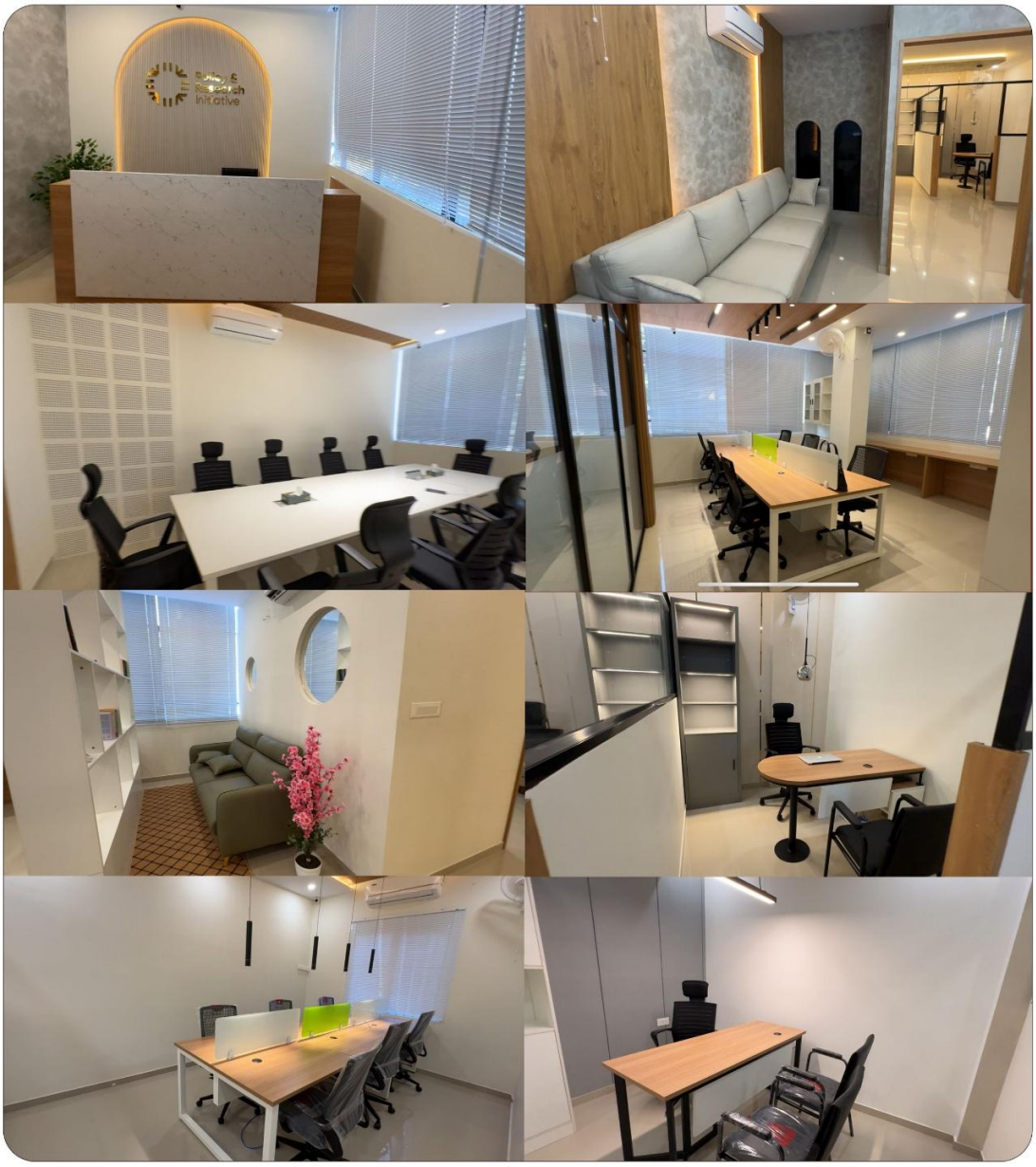
- **Fully Air-Conditioned Facility (1400 sq.ft)** designed for research & development work
- **Common Workspace:** Seating capacity for **12 full-time staff**
- **Dedicated Digital Workspace: 8-seat** technical & data analysis section
- **Meeting Room:** Conference setup for **15 participants**, multimedia-enabled
- **Individual Research Cabins: 3 units**
- **Director Cabins: 2 units**
- **Pantry & Sanitation Facilities**

Functional Purpose

- Serves as the **daily operational centre** for full-time researchers, analysts, and administrative staff.

- Provides **open-access workspace** for visiting scholars, fellows, interns, and collaborators from diverse universities and research backgrounds.
- Supports **data repository functions**, digital documentation, and multimedia production for outreach and public engagement.

PRI OFFICE



3. Programmes, Workshops & Public Engagements

PRI actively engages with **students, research scholars, academic institutions, and government-aligned initiatives** to promote research literacy, electoral awareness, and data-driven decision-making.

3.1 Major Programmes Conducted

a. SIR: "Update Today, Decide Tomorrow."





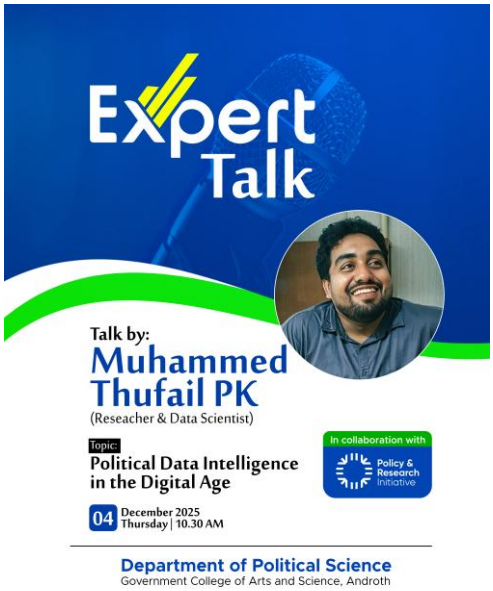


Date: 02/11/2025, 11.00 AM
Venue: MES Mampad College
Collaborators: Electoral Literacy Club & Aikhya Students' Union
Lead Speaker: *Muhammed Thufail*
Focus Areas:

- Understanding the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of the electoral rolls
- Legal framework of voter enrolment
- Role of youth in democratic processes

- Empowering students to participate responsibly in democratic institutions

b. “Political Data Intelligence in the Digital Age.”





Date: 04/12/2025, 10.30 AM
Venue: Department of Political Science, Government College of Arts & Science, Androth, Lakshadweep (Online)

Collaborator: PRI

Speaker: *Muhammed Thufail*
Presided By: *Dr. Anees Vavad*
Focus Areas:

- Digital transformation in governance
- Use of big data for political and development analysis
- Strengthening democratic processes through technology
- Ethical data systems and civic empowerment

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4. Fellowships & Internships

PRI supports researchers and students through structured programmes to enhance academic rigor and policy innovation.

4.1 Fellowship Programme

Fellow:

Hisham (Ph.D., Eco IIT Delhi)
Topic: *Trend Analysis of Kerala PSC Appointments & Policy Reforms*
Objective:

- Examine historical and contemporary patterns in PSC recruitment.
- Assess the impact of reservation rotation systems on marginalized communities.
- Provide data-driven policy recommendations to enhance equity and representation.

4.2 Internship Programme

Intern:

Muhammed Sinan (MBA Analytics, Delhi School of Economics)
Project: *Examining School Educational Quality in Kerala*
Activities:

- Data collection from various sources about schools across regions (UDISE+, KITE Kerala)
- Building a comparative educational dashboard
- Identifying gaps in infrastructure, learning outcomes, and quality indicators

PRI's internship programme promotes **capacity building**, encourages **youth participation in development studies**, and strengthens research skills aligned with national educational objectives.

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5. Ongoing Research Projects

PRI has established **thematic research centres** to systematically study Kerala's socio-economic landscape. Below are the active departments and projects, expanded using your earlier planning documents.

5.1 Demography & Population Studies

Head: Dr. Afsal K
Researcher: Irshad CV

Key Research Themes

- Kerala's shifting age structure & implications of ageing
- Migration patterns (inward, outward, Gulf migration)
- Fertility trends & demographic transition
- District-wise population pyramids and projections
- Aging Population and Kerala's Social Security.

PRI maintains **district-wise demographic models**, **age-pyramid datasets**, and **population projections** for use by researchers and policymakers.

5.2 Education Research

Head: Dr. Muneer K (IIM Bangalore)**

Key Work Areas

- Mapping school infrastructure using **UDISE+** datasets
- District-level analysis of enrolment trends, dropout patterns, and learning outcomes
- Higher education capacity analysis using **AISHE**
- Access, equity, and affordability in Kerala's education ecosystem

- Infrastructure dashboards for government schools

This work supports **evidence-informed decisions in Kerala's education planning**.

5.3 Election & Democracy Research Unit

Head: Dr. Noushad T**

Key Focus Areas

- **Empowering grassroots representation & electoral participation.**
- Analysis of delimitation methodologies for improved representation.
- Public awareness materials promoting **democratic participation.**

PRI aims to strengthen **transparent, inclusive, and participatory democracy** by bridging research with public education.

5.4 Data Science, Digital Governance & Repository Systems

Key Activities

- Development of **Python-based scraping systems** and AI tools for collecting publicly available data on education, development & policies.
- Building the **PRI Digital Data Repository** on Education & Policy.
- Integration of NFHS, Census, UDISE+, AISHE, CMIE, NSSO datasets

These systems ensure that PRI functions as a **modern, digital-first research institution** aligned with global best practices.

6. Future Programmes & Institutional Expansion Plan

PRI envisions a comprehensive set of future programmes that strengthen its role as a **data-driven policy institution**, support government-aligned development objectives, and promote inclusive, evidence-based public discourse. These programmes will cut across research, outreach,

digital innovation, and institutional networking, ensuring that the organisation continues to evolve into a robust centre for policy analysis and civic empowerment.

6.1. Expansion of Research & Analysis Initiatives

PRI will continue to deepen and widen its research footprint through:

- Identification of new policy-relevant domains such as **education quality, health equity, Gender & Social Justice, Environment, Climate & Sustainability, demography, migration, labour markets, media and digital societies**, and public systems governance.

- Launching multiple short-term and long-term research projects that address pressing socio-economic issues and provide actionable insights to policymakers.

- Conducting **case studies, comparative analyses, district-level assessments**, and data-backed evaluations to support government departments, civil society organisations, and academic communities.

- Supporting interdisciplinary research teams, thematic departments, and expert committees to advance sector-focused knowledge production.

6.2. Development of a State-Level Data Repository & Research Lab

PRI aims to establish a comprehensive digital research ecosystem through:

- Acquisition, curation, and organisation of **large-scale secondary datasets** relating to population, health, education, employment, local governance, and public finances.

- Building automated systems such as **GIS-based data mapping, public dashboards, API-driven data access**, and real-time monitoring tools to enhance research quality and transparency.

- Expanding the digital library to host **research papers, government reports, surveys, academic studies, archival documents**, and open-access publications.

- Establishing an **AI-driven research lab** to support advanced analytical models, forecasting, text mining, and large-scale data processing.

6.3. Outreach, Public Education & Knowledge Dissemination

PRI will strengthen its public-facing programmes through:

- Publishing **policy briefs, white papers, research summaries, infographics, and multimedia explainers** to make research accessible to students, policymakers, and the public.
- Producing multilingual content (English, Malayalam) to ensure accessibility across diverse communities.
- Creating a **production house** for developing visual content, podcasts, video explainers, and public education series.
- Partnering with **mainstream media outlets, educational institutions, and community networks** for wider dissemination of research-driven insights.
- Implementing structured **media monitoring and response mechanisms** to counter misinformation with factual, data-backed communication.

6.4. Strengthening Advocacy & Policy Engagement Programmes

PRI will expand its policy-oriented engagement through:

- Hosting **policy dialogues, leadership roundtables, thematic workshops**, and capacity-building sessions with elected representatives, administrators, and institutional leaders.
- Preparing technical notes, evidence summaries, and briefing documents for government stakeholders to support informed decision-making.
- Designing **targeted public-interest campaigns** on developmental issues such as education reforms, electoral transparency, demographic shifts, and governance innovations.

- Creating frameworks for **impact measurement** to evaluate how PRI's work influences public policy and institutional practices.

6.5. Networking, Researchers' Society & Institutional Partnerships

PRI aims to build a vibrant ecosystem of knowledge-sharing through:

- Expanding the **PRI Researchers' Society** into a large interdisciplinary network of scholars, students, and practitioners.

- Forming and supporting **subject-specific expert workgroups** that contribute to collaborative projects and thematic studies.

- Organising the **PRI Research Summit**, training workshops, and collaborative programmes with universities, think tanks, and non-governmental organisations.

- Strengthening partnerships through **MoUs with academic institutions, research centres, civil society organisations**, and development agencies.

- Facilitating fellowship and internship programmes to nurture young researchers and promote academic engagement.

6.6. Organisational Strengthening & Infrastructure Development

PRI is committed to building a stable and future-ready institutional structure through:

- Enhancing **IT infrastructure, data security systems, communication tools**, and compliance protocols.

- Establishing continuous **review, monitoring, and evaluation mechanisms** for project quality and institutional effectiveness.
- Expanding administrative, research, and technical teams to support the growing scale of programmes.
- Strengthening sustainable funding channels and donor engagement frameworks in alignment with legal and regulatory guidelines.
- Maintaining a professional research workspace that enables scholars, fellows, and collaborators to work effectively.

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7. Conclusion

Through these future programmes, PRI aims to evolve into a **leading policy research institution**, contributing to national development priorities, fostering inclusive civic participation, and strengthening evidence-based governance. These initiatives will enhance PRI's capacity to serve the public, support government agencies, generate high-quality research, and promote constitutional values through rigorous, data-backed inquiry.